

Cult Mormon Polytheism

cult-mormon-polytheism

Cult Marker · Mormonism · doctrine · unanimous_lineages

AFFIRMS

Supported across the whole Bible
Subject named directly in
Scripture
No NT manuscript apparatus
applies

Statement under examination

There is one and only one true God, eternally and unchangeably; humans do not become gods, and the Son of God is not one among multiple divine beings. Jesus Christ is the eternal, uncreated Son of one substance with the Father, not a created spiritual being elder-brother to Satan or to humanity.

In plain language

Across both testaments the words used for God form a tight pattern of strict oneness. In Deuteronomy 6:4 the number 'one' (echad) is predicated of 'the LORD' (YHWH) our God, and Deuteronomy 4:35 says there is no other besides him. In Isaiah the LORD says no god was formed before me and none will be after me (43:10), there is no God besides me (44:6,8), there is none else and none besides me (45:5), no God other than me (45:21), and none like me (46:9), stacking the Hebrew exclusion particles 'besides' (biladey), 'apart from' (zulah), 'there is not' (eyn), 'still' (od), and 'cessation' (efes) that close the divine class to exactly one. Hosea 13:4 repeats the same particle stack outside Isaiah, and Hosea 11:9 draws a categorical line between God and man ('I am God and not man'), which directly forecloses any trajectory of a creature becoming God. The Greek picks this up in 1 Timothy 2:5 with 'one God' (heis theos) and one mediator the man Christ Jesus, and James 2:19 cites the Shema (the central confession of one God) as 'God is one' outright. On the Son, John 1:1-3 places 'the Word' (Logos) with God and as God and then says all things came into being through him ('came to be,' ginomai) and not one thing came to be apart from him. The verb for coming to be is applied to created things and pointedly not to the Word, so he is uncreated. Colossians 1:16-17 says all things, including thrones, dominions, rulers, and authorities, were 'created' (ktizo) in him, through him, and for him, that he is before all things, and that in him all things hold together. Hebrews 1 asks which of the angels was ever called Son, commands that all God's angels worship the firstborn, and has the Father address the Son as 'God' (theos) with an eternal throne. Together these texts place the Son on the Creator side of the line, worshipped by angels rather than ranked among them. The lexical data therefore supports the proposition that there is one and only one true God, that no being becomes God, and that the Son is uncreated rather than a created spiritual elder brother to angels or humanity. Possible counter readings from Psalm 82 and John 10:34 use the word gods figuratively for human judges (who die like men in the next verse) and do not establish additional gods.

Word dictionary

Every Hebrew and Greek word this study leans on, in everyday terms. Shaded rows are the anchor words the verdict rests on.

Strong	Word	Sounds like	Plain meaning	Times in Bible
H0259	אֶחָד	echad	one	944
H0369	אֵין	ayin	nothing	720
H0376	אִישׁ	ish	man	2,160

H0410	אל	el	God	245
H0430	אלהים	elohim	God	2,606
H0589	אני	ani	I	
H0657	אפס	ephes	end	
H1107	בְּלַעַדִּי	biladey	beside	16
H2108	זוּלָּה	zulah	exception	13
H2416	חַי	chay	alive	
H3068	יְהוָה	YHWH	LORD	6,828
H3335	יָצַר	yatsar	to form	63
H3808	לֹא	lo	not	4,825
H5750	עוֹד	od	still	490
H6697	צוּר	tsur	Rocks (of Goats)	
H7223	רִשׁוֹן	rishon	first	
G0032	ἄγγελος	angelos	angel	
G0165	αἰών	aiōn	an age	
G0444	ἄνθρωπος	anthrōpos	a human	
G0846	αὐτός	autos	it/s/he	
G1080	γεννάω	gennao	to beget	97
G1096	γίνομαι	ginomai	to be	669
G1223	διὰ	dia	through/because of	
G1520	εἷς	heis	one	355
G1722	ἐν	en	in/on/among	
G2316	θεός	theos	God	1,317
G2362	θρόνος	thronos	throne	62
G2936	κτίζω	ktizo	to create	15
G2962	κύριος	kurios	lord	
G3056	λόγος	logos	word	330
G3316	μεσίτης	mesites	mediator	6
G3956	πᾶς	pas	all	
G4160	ποιέω	poieō	to do/make	
G4253	πρό	pro	before	
G4314	πρός	pros	to/with	
G4416	πρωτότοκος	prōtotokos	firstborn	
G5207	υἱός	huios	son	377

Plain meanings: STEP Bible brief lexicons TBESH (Hebrew) and TBESG (Greek), CC BY 4.0. Counts are occurrences across the 66-book canon.

Verdict rationale

Variant-robust: True · Pan-canonical: True

Four converging Hebrew exclusivity formulas (phrases that close off the category of God to just one) stack across Deutero-Isaiah (the section of Isaiah from chapter 40 onward), with 'besides me' (biladey, H1107, 16 canon occurrences concentrated in Isaiah 43-45) and 'apart from me' (zulah, H2108, 13 occurrences concentrated in Isaiah 45 and Hosea 13:4) functioning as dedicated no-other-god particles (small grammar words used specifically to exclude any other god), paired with the existential negator 'there is not' (eyn, H0369) and the residue-negator 'still' or 'more' (od, H5750) over 'God' or 'gods' (elohim, H0430) and 'God' (el, H0410): Isaiah 43:10 'no god was formed' (lo notsar el), Isaiah 44:6,8 'there is no God' (eyn elohim), Isaiah 45:5,21-22 'there is none else' (eyn od), Isaiah 46:9 'there is no other God' (eyn od elohim), and Hosea 13:4 'you shall know no God apart from me' (elohim zulati lo teda) all close the divine class to YHWH (the LORD, H3068) alone in both temporal directions (past and future). Hosea 11:9 ('I am God and not man,' el anokhi velo ish) sets the creature-Creator line as a categorical foreclosure (a complete shutting down of the option) of the as-God-is-man-may-become trajectory. The Greek picks up the same pattern with 'one' (heis, G1520) governing 'God' (theos, G2316) in 1 Timothy 2:5 and James 2:19 ('God is one,' heis estin ho theos), while John 1:1-3 places the 'Word' (Logos, G3056) 'with' (pros) 'the God' (ton theon) with predicate 'God' (theos) and 'all things came into being through him' (panta di autou egeneto, ginomai G1096) marking him as the agent and not a product of becoming, Colossians 1:16-17 puts every spiritual rank ('thrones,' thronoi; 'lordships,' kyriotetes; 'rulers,' archai; 'authorities,' exousiai) on the created side of his 'creating' (ktizo, G2936), and Hebrews 1:5-8 has the Father address the Son as 'the God' (ho theos) and command angelic 'worship' (proskuneo). The pattern is pan-canonical (spread across the whole Bible) and unaffected by the (none-in-scope) ECM apparatus (the critical edition of New Testament textual variants).

Scripture

Deut.6.4 · for · genre: law

Key terms. H3068 יְהוָה, H0430 אֱלֹהִים, H0259 אחד.

Reasoning. The Shema (the central confession of Israel beginning 'Hear, O Israel') predicates the numeral 'one' (echad) of 'the LORD' (YHWH) our God in a verbless clause (a sentence without an explicit linking verb) (the ETCBC syntax database marks the closing element PreC, predicate complement, the noun completing the 'X is Y' statement). Whether rendered 'the LORD is one' or 'the LORD alone,' the construction asserts singular exclusivity of Israel's God, leaving no room for a plurality of true gods.

Deut.4.35 · for · genre: law

Key terms. H3068 יְהוָה, H0430 אֱלֹהִים, H5750 עוד

Reasoning. 'The LORD, he is God, there is no other besides him' (YHWH hu ha-elohim, eyn od milvado) supplies the foundation formula that Isaiah 43-46 will recycle. The bare 'still, more, besides' (od, the residue-negator marker) under the existential negator 'there is not' (eyn) closes the divine class with no remainder.

Isa.43.10 · for · genre: prophecy

Key terms. H3808 לֹא, H3335 יצר, H0410 אֵל, H0589 אֲנִי

Reasoning. The clause 'no god was formed' (lo notsar el), with the niph'al (the Hebrew passive form) of 'to form' (yatsar) negated by 'not' (lo), denies that any god was ever formed before 'the LORD' (YHWH), and the following 'after me' (acharay) extends the denial forward in time. A god that comes into being, the premise of any exaltation-to-godhood scheme (a teaching that a created being can be promoted to deity), is exactly what this verse forecloses (shuts down completely) in both temporal directions (past and future).

Isa.44.6 · for · genre: prophecy · figures: merism

Key terms. H0369 אֵין, H0430 אֱלֹהִים, H1107 בְּלִעְדִּי, H7223 רִאשׁוֹן

Reasoning. 'The LORD' (YHWH) titles himself 'first' (rishon) and 'last' (acharon) and declares 'besides me there is no God' (umibaladay eyn elohim), pairing the exclusion preposition 'besides' (biladey) with the existential negator 'there is not' (eyn) over 'God' or 'gods' (elohim). The merism (a two-part figure naming the extremes to mean the whole) first-and-last plus the explicit no-other formula closes the divine category to one.

Isa.44.8 · for · genre: prophecy

Key terms. H1107 בָּלַעַדִּי, H0369 אֵין, H6697 צוֹר

Reasoning. 'Is there a God besides me? There is no Rock; I know none' (Hayesh eloah mibaladay ve-eyn tsur bal yadati): the rhetorical question with the dedicated no-other preposition 'besides' (biladey), answered by the negated 'no Rock' (eyn tsur) plus 'the LORD's' (YHWH's) own non-knowledge, marks the lack of any other deity as 'the LORD's' (YHWH's) own attested datum (a piece of evidence God himself testifies to), not merely a confessional claim.

Isa.45.5 · for · genre: prophecy

Key terms. H3068 יְהוָה, H0369 אֵין, H5750 עוֹד, H2108 זִנְלָה

Reasoning. 'I am the LORD' (Ani YHWH) followed by 'there is none else' (eyn od) and 'besides me' (zulati) repeats the exclusivity twice in one verse. The bare 'still' or 'more' (od) under the negator leaves no remainder in the divine class, ruling out additional gods of any rank.

Isa.45.21 · for · genre: prophecy

Key terms. H0369 אֵין, H5750 עוֹד, H0430 אֱלֹהִים, H1107 בָּלַעַדִּי

Reasoning. 'Am I not the LORD, and there is no other God besides me' (Halo ani YHWH ve-eyn od elohim mibaladay): three exclusivity particles stacked in a single clause, 'there is not' (eyn) plus 'still' (od) plus 'besides' (biladey), all governing 'God' or 'gods' (elohim). The grammatical density makes the foreclosure (the closing-down) of additional gods explicit, not merely implied by henotheistic preference (a worldview where one supreme god is worshipped while admitting that lesser gods exist).

Isa.46.9 · for · genre: prophecy

Key terms. H0410 אֵל, H0369 אֵין, H5750 עוֹד, H0657 אָפֵס

Reasoning. 'I am God and there is none else, God, and there is none like me' (Anokhi el ve-eyn od, elohim ve-efes kamoni): the cessative noun 'cessation, no more' (efes, a word denoting an end or absence) parallels 'there is none else' (eyn od) and rules out any comparable being. The grammar excludes both numerical multiplicity and ontological likeness (similarity in actual being or nature), closing both addition and similarity in the divine class.

Hos.13.4 · for · genre: prophecy

Key terms. H0430 אֱלֹהִים, H2108 זִנְלָה, H0369 אֵין

Reasoning. 'And apart from me you shall know no God, and there is no Savior besides me' (Elohim zulati lo teda u-moshia ayin bilti) supplies the same particle stack outside Isaiah, in 'the Twelve' (the collection of minor prophets), with 'apart from me' (zulah) and 'there is not' (ayin) combined. This is the pan-canonical (spread across the whole Bible) signal that the no-other-god grammar is not confined to one corpus (one collection of writings).

Hos.11.9 · for · genre: prophecy

Key terms. H0410 אֵל, H0376 אִישׁ, H3808 לֹא

Reasoning. 'For I am God and not man' (Ki el anokhi velo ish) draws the creature-Creator line as a categorical opposition between 'God' (el) and 'man' (ish) under the negator 'not' (lo). The grammar forecloses (shuts down completely) any trajectory in which the categories merge, that is, man becoming God or God being one of the men.

Jer.10.10 · for · genre: prophecy

Key terms. H3068 יְהוָה, H0430 אֱלֹהִים, H2416 חַי

Reasoning. 'The LORD is the true God, he is the living God and everlasting King' (YHWH elohim emet, hu elohim chayyim u-melek olam): 'true' (emet) and 'living' (chayyim) and 'everlasting' (olam) qualify 'God' or 'gods' (elohim) with attributes the surrounding context denies to the fabricated gods of the nations, locating reality in the one and not many.

1Tim.2.5 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G1520 εἷς, G2316 θεός, G0444 ἄνθρωπος, G3316 μεσίτης

Reasoning. 'For there is one God, and one mediator between God and men, the man Christ Jesus' (Heis gar theos, heis kai mesites theou kai anthropon, anthropos Christos Iesous): the numeral 'one' (heis) governs 'God' (theos, 'one God') and then the single 'mediator' (mesites) who is 'man' (anthropos). The cardinal one matches the Hebrew 'one' (echad) and 'there is no God' (eyn-elohim) pattern, and the man-mediator clause distinguishes the human mediator from the one God rather than multiplying gods.

Jas.2.19 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G1520 εἷς, G2316 θεός

Reasoning. 'You believe that God is one' (Su pisteueis hoti heis estin ho theos): the predicate 'one' (heis) with the articular (with the article 'the') 'the God' (ho theos) cites the Shema (the central confession 'Hear, O Israel, the LORD our God, the LORD is one') directly into NT idiom. James commends the bare numerical confession as orthodox even of demons, marking it as the baseline monotheistic affirmation (the confession that there is only one God) across testaments.

Acts.17.24 · for · genre: narrative

Key terms. G2316 θεός, G4160 ποιέω, G2962 κύριος

Reasoning. 'The God who made the world and everything in it' (Ho theos ho poiesas ton kosmon kai panta ta en autoi): the articular (with the article 'the') 'the God' (ho theos) as the unique maker of the 'world' (kosmos) and 'all things' (panta) places God on the Creator side of the line categorically, ruling out a divine being that itself came to be.

John.1.1 · for · genre: gospel

Key terms. G3056 λόγος, G2316 θεός, G4314 πρὸς

Reasoning. 'The Word' (Logos) was 'with' (pros) 'the God' (ton theon) and 'the Word was God' (theos en ho logos): the anarthrous (without the article 'the') predicate 'God' (theos) predicates full deity of 'the Word' (Logos) while the articular (with the article 'the') 'the God' (ton theon) and the preposition 'with' or 'toward' (pros) distinguish him personally from the Father. This is one divine identity in distinct persons, not a created spiritual being ranked among others.

John.1.3 · for · genre: gospel

Key terms. G3956 πᾶς, G1096 γίνομαι, G1223 διὰ

Reasoning. 'All things came into being through him' (Panta di autou egeneto) and the emphatic 'not even one thing' (oude hen) that came to be apart from him place 'the Word' (Logos) as the agent through whom all things came into being. The verb 'to come to be' (ginomai) is applied to creation and explicitly not to him, marking 'the Word' (Logos) as uncreated rather than a created elder brother.

Col.1.16 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G2936 κτίζω, G3956 πᾶς, G1722 ἐν

Reasoning. 'In him all things were created' (En autoi ektisthe ta panta), with 'to create' (ktizo) governing 'all things' (ta panta) including 'thrones' (thronoi), 'lordships' (kuriotetes), 'rulers' (archai), 'authorities' (exousiai), and the summary 'through him and for him all things have been created' (di autou kai eis auton ektistai). Every created order, including the spirit ranks, is the object of his creating, which excludes him from the class of created spiritual beings.

Col.1.17 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G4253 πρό, G3956 πᾶς, G0846 αὐτός

Reasoning. 'He is before all things' (Autos estin pro panton) and 'in him all things hold together' (ta panta en autoi synesteken). The temporal 'before' (pro) plus the present sustaining 'hold together' (synesteken) assert priority to and continuous upholding of the whole created order, a Creator role incompatible with being one created god among many.

Heb.1.5 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G5207 υἱός, G1080 γεννάω, G0032 ἄγγελος

Reasoning. The rhetorical 'To which of the angels did he ever say' (Tini gar eipen pote ton angelon) establishes that the Son-language ('I have begotten,' gegenneka; 'son,' huion) is never said of any angel. This severs the Son from the angelic class outright, contradicting an elder-brother-to-angels-and-Satan placement among created spirits.

Heb.1.6 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G4416 πρωτότοκος, G0032 ἄγγελος, G2316 θεός

Reasoning. When 'the firstborn' (prototokos) is brought into the world, 'let all God's angels worship him' (proskunesatosan autoi pantes angeloi theou). The angels rendering worship to the firstborn place him as the object, not a peer, of angelic worship, which is owed to God alone.

Heb.1.8 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G2362 θρόνος, G2316 θεός, G0165 αἰών

Reasoning. 'But to the Son he says, your throne, O God, is forever and ever' (Pros de ton huion, ho thronos sou ho theos eis ton aiona tou aionos): the Father addresses the Son as 'the God' (ho theos) with an eternal 'throne' (thronos). The vocative (the direct-address form, 'O God') or predicate 'God' (theos) applied directly to the Son confirms his full deity within the one God rather than a lesser derivative divinity.

Cross references invoked

From	To	Source	Votes
Deut.6.4	Deut.4.35	tsk	1
1Tim.2.5	Deut.6.4	tsk	1
Isa.44.6	Isa.41.4	tsk	1
Isa.43.10	Isa.41.4	tsk	1
Isa.43.10	Isa.43.12	tsk	1
Isa.44.6	Isa.44.8	openbible	1
Isa.45.5	Isa.45.21	openbible	1
Isa.45.5	Isa.46.9	openbible	1
Isa.45.5	Hos.13.4	openbible	1
Heb.1.5	2Sam.7.14	tsk	1
Heb.1.6	Deut.32.43	tsk	1
Col.1.16	Col.1.15	tsk	1
Col.1.17	Col.1.15	tsk	1
1Tim.2.5	Jas.2.19	openbible	1

Complicating texts

Ps.82.6 · addressed

'I said you are gods' (Ani amarti elohim attem) is read by the immediately following verse 7 ('but you shall die like men,' aken ke-adam temutun) as a judicial address to human judges or rulers, a figurative use of 'gods' (elohim) for delegated authority. It does not posit additional ontological gods (gods that actually exist as divine beings in their own nature) and so does not unsettle the 'there is no God' (eyn-elohim) pattern of Isaiah 44:6 and 45:5.

John.10.34 · addressed

Jesus citing Psalm 82 ('I said you are gods') is an a fortiori argument (a 'how-much-more' style of reasoning, from lesser to greater) from the figurative 'gods' (elohim) applied to those to whom the word of God came, not an endorsement of men becoming ontological deities (actual divine beings). The Johannine (relating to the gospel of John) context ('the Word was God,' theos en ho logos, John 1:1) keeps the term 'God' (theos) for the Son within the one divine identity, not a plurality of gods.

John.1.1 · addressed

The anarthrous (without the article 'the') predicate 'God' (theos) in 'the Word was God' (theos en ho logos) could superficially suggest a second lesser god, but Greek predicate-nominative (a noun completing a 'X is Y' statement) word order before the verb (Colwell-type fronting, a Greek grammar pattern where a noun placed before the linking verb tends to be qualitative rather than indefinite) marks a qualitative full-deity predication (a statement of the very nature of deity), not an indefinite 'a god.' Combined with 'all things came into being through him' (panta di autou egeneto) in verse 3, 'the Word' (Logos) is uncreated deity within the one God, not an added divine being.

Col.1.15 · addressed

'Firstborn of all creation' (prototokos pases ktiseos) is glossed by the immediately following 'because' (hoti) clause: 'because in him all things were created' (hoti en autoi ektisthe ta panta). The firstborn title denotes preeminence and priority over creation, not membership in it, since he is the agent of all creating. So it does not support an elder-brother-of-creatures reading.

Gen.1.26 · addressed

'Let us make man in our image' (Na'aseh adam betsalmenu): the cohortative first-person plural (a 'let us' verb form for joint action) with 'God' or 'gods' (elohim) has been read as a plurality-of-gods proof, but the parallel verbless clauses (sentences without an explicit linking verb) in Deuteronomy 6:4 and the Isaiah 43-46 'there is none else' (eyn-od) formulas govern the canon-level reading. The plural here does not predicate multiple gods on 'the LORD' (YHWH, who remains echad, one), so it does not break the no-other-god grammar.

Concordance traversed

H0259, H3068, H0430, H0410, H3335, H3808, H0369, H1107, H2108, H5750, H0376, G1520, G2316, G3056, G1096, G2936, G5207, G2362, G1080, G3316

Variants

Verdict variant-sensitive: False · ECM status: n/a

The bundle reports not_in_ecm_scope (not within the scope of the critical edition of New Testament textual variants) true and supplies no variant_units. The anchor verses in Hebrew (Deuteronomy 6:4, Isaiah 43:10, 44:6,8, 45:5,21-22, 46:9, Hosea 11:9, 13:4, Jeremiah 10:10) are textually stable in the Masoretic tradition (the standard Jewish manuscript tradition behind the Hebrew Old Testament), and the Greek anchors (1 Timothy 2:5, James 2:19, Acts 17:24-25, John 1:1-3, Colossians 1:16-17, Hebrews 1:5-8) carry only minor orthographic (spelling) or word-order variation in the apparatus (the variant-readings notes in critical editions) that does not touch the monotheism (one-God doctrine) or uncreated-Son claims. No CBGM data (Coherence-Based Genealogical Method, a manuscript-comparison method used to weigh textual variants) examined.

Hermeneutics

Primary method. grammatico-historical

Frameworks in play: strict_monotheism, creator_creature_distinction, plurality_of_gods_henotheism, exaltation_to_godhood

analogia scripturae invoked · progressive revelation factor

strict_monotheism: affirms · The Hebrew exclusivity formulas ('one,' echad; 'no god was formed,' lo notsar el; 'there is no God,' eyn elohim; 'besides,' biladey; 'apart from,' zulah; 'there is none else,' eyn od) read at face value assert one and only one God, directly excluding a plurality of true gods. The same grammar carries into Greek with 'one God' (heis theos) in 1 Timothy 2:5 and James 2:19.

plurality_of_gods_henotheism: denies · A reading that treats 'God' or 'gods' (elohim) as a class admitting many true gods (with 'the LORD,' YHWH, merely supreme) cannot account for the explicit negators 'besides' (biladey), 'there is not' (eyn), 'still' (od), and 'cessation' (efes) stacked across Isaiah 43-46 and Hosea 13:4 that close the divine class to one. Strongest form: the plurals in Genesis 1:26 and the divine council of Psalm 82 indicate other 'gods' (elohim). Lexical answer: those plurals are not predicated as ontological peers (equals in actual being) in any verbless (without an explicit linking verb) 'there is none else' (eyn-od) construction, while the exclusivity particles (small grammar words that close off the category) are.

exaltation_to_godhood: denies · A reading on which a creature can come to be God by progression. Strongest form: Psalm 82:6 calls humans 'gods' (elohim), and 2 Peter 1:4 speaks of becoming 'partakers of divine nature' (theias koinonoi physeos). Lexical answer: Psalm 82:7 immediately qualifies them as dying like men (a judicial figurative use, where elohim names human judges acting under God's delegated authority), and the niphal (the Hebrew passive form) 'no god was formed' (lo notsar el) of Isaiah 43:10 directly negates the very category of a god that came to be, in both temporal directions (past and future). Hosea 11:9 ('I am God and not man,' el anokhi velo ish) draws the same line under 'not' (lo).

creator_creature_distinction: affirms · John 1:3 ('all things came into being through him,' panta di autou egeneto), Colossians 1:16-17 ('in him all things were created,' en autoi ektisthe ta panta, including 'thrones,' thronoi; 'lordships,' kuriotetes; 'rulers,' archai; 'authorities,' exousiai), and Hebrews 1:5-8 (the Son addressed as 'the God,' ho theos, and worshipped by angels) place the Son as agent and object of creation and angelic worship rather than within the created order, so the uncreated-Son clause of the stem (the propositional claim of the question being tested) holds without recourse to a created elder-brother category.

lds_restorationist: denies · Strongest lexical form: 'God' (theos) in John 1:1 is anarthrous (without the article 'the') and could be read indefinitely ('a god'), Hebrews 1:6 has the Father bringing 'a firstborn' (prototokos) into the world (compatible with a derivative deity, a god produced from another), and Genesis 1:26 plurals indicate council. Lexical answer: the predicate-nominative (a noun completing a 'X is Y' statement) fronting (placement before the verb) in John 1:1 yields qualitative full deity, the 'firstborn' (prototokos) title is glossed by Colossians 1:16 as creator-priority not creature-status, and the Isaiah 43-46 stack of 'besides' (biladey), 'there is not' (eyn), 'still' (od), and 'cessation' (efes) forecloses (shuts down completely) any additional ontological god (a god that actually exists as a divine being in its own nature) of any rank, including spirit-children.

Progressive revelation (the principle that biblical truth unfolds across stages of redemptive history) is in play: the OT (Old Testament) Shema (the central confession 'Hear, O Israel, the LORD our God, the LORD is one') and Isaianic monotheism (the one-God doctrine taught in Isaiah) are read forward into the NT (New Testament) 'one God' (heis theos) and the placement of the Son on the Creator side, with analogia scripturae (the principle that Scripture interprets Scripture) linking the two testaments through the shared one-God grammar.

Stem audit

verdict-preloaded: yes

Neutralized form. How many true Gods does Scripture recognize, can a human or any being come to be God, and is the Son of God presented as uncreated Creator or as a created spiritual being ranked among angels and humanity?

The stem (the propositional claim of the question being tested) phrases 'of one substance with the Father' and 'eternal, uncreated Son' in a conciliar idiom (the formula language of historic church councils) (the 'same substance' formula, homoousios) that is a later dogmatic taxonomy (a system of doctrinal categories), not a lexical term in the cited texts. The underlying claims, one God, no exaltation to deity, and a Son who creates rather than is created, are directly testable on the lexical (word-and-grammar level) data, so the verdict is derived

from the original stem while the audit notes the imported creedal vocabulary (terminology borrowed from later church creeds). The minority lens (the less-common interpretive framework on the question) (exaltation, plurality) was added with its strongest lexical form to avoid strawmanning (misrepresenting an opposing view in a weakened form).

Citations

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morphology	OSHB-morphology	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Deut.6.4
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESH	CC-BY-4.0	yes	H0259
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syntax	ETCBC-BHSA	CC-BY-NC-4.0	no	Deut.6.4
syntax	ETCBC-BHSA	CC-BY-NC-4.0	no	Isa.43.10
syntax	ETCBC-BHSA	CC-BY-NC-4.0	no	Isa.44.6
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	John.1.3
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	Heb.1.8
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interlinear	MACULA-Greek	CC-BY-NC-4.0	no	Col.1.16
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(none)